
UNIT 12 FEATURE AND NEWS AGENCIES

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12.0 INTRODUCTION

Mastering the art of speech and writing had been done long before but not the speed of communication. It came much later. After the invention of telegraph in

the nineteenth century, the world had started witnessing a revolution in the flow of information. The invention is nothing short of the invention of Printing Press itself. For a long time, news travelled by smoke signals, runners by foot and at the speed of the horse. The scenario changed dramatically with the steam engines and telegraph appearing in the mid nineteenth century. Both French man Charles Louis Havas, the pioneer in starting a news agency and Briton Julius Reuter, who founded international news agency after his name - Reuters, used even carrier pigeons, balloons and telegraph to send across news. Bernhard Wolff in Germany and Associated press across the Atlantic in US joined them to dominate the news agency operation in the world. The rapid industrialisation and sweeping political changes in Europe and across the world created the need for faster and reliable flow of news and information. Individual papers couldn't meet the need because of limited resources. Thus news agencies occupied the central place in gathering and distribution of news.

12.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After working through the unit, you will be able to:

- state the origin and growth of news agency;
- differentiate its function from news papers;
- describe the function of a news agency and its feature services;
- outline the growth of news agency in India;
- analyse the changes that happened in Emergency;
- discuss the ownership pattern and income resources;
- describe the state of language wings;
- enlist foreign news agencies working in India; and
- project the competition in the present world scenario.

12.2 WHAT IS A NEWS AGENCY

12.2.1 Basic Features

New agency was described earlier as an organisation that collects and distributes news to news papers, magazines and broadcasters. But this definition doesn't fit in to today's world. They have diversified their operations from just news suppliers to several other income earning services to survive the competition in the present high tech world. Apart from distributing news to news papers, these days they supply news and video footages to TV news broadcasters, news and information texts to mobile phone services and operate online web news services. Some of them are advertisers and publishers too.

Therefore, News Agency can be described as an organisation that gathers news items, photos and news video footages and market and other information of interest to the people and distributes them to news papers, magazines, Radio and Television broadcasters, mobile phones, government agencies and other subscribers. These are also referred to as a wire service, newswire or news service.

12.2.2 Origin

Charles Havas was credited with starting the world's first news agency- Bureau Havas - in France in 1832. He was running a lithographic news service to collect and translate news stories of foreign press. With his own correspondents to report to him later, he christened his agency as 'Agence Havas' in 1835 to provide a wide range of services to newspapers and bankers besides French government ministers and departments. After several developments and change of hands, the news agency he started became Agence France - Presse popularly known today as AFP. Israel Beer Josaphat, a German Jew, who came to England as Julius Josaphat, baptized as a Christian later as Paul Julius Reuter was working as Sub Editor with Havas in Paris before venturing out to start his own news agency Reuters in 1851. So also Bernhard Wolff, who was a colleague of Reuter working with Havas, went on to set up Wolff of Prussia in 1849 in Germany to make it one of the three major news agencies. But it couldn't survive after World War -1. After the 2nd world war, the present German News Agency Deutsche Presse - Agentur (DPA), which succeeded the Deutsche Nachrichtenagentur-establishe, was established in 1949. Based in Hamburgh, it has grown to be a major worldwide news operation in German, English, Spanish and Arabic languages.

Across the Atlantic, Associated Press (AP) emerged as a solution to beat the high cost of telegraphy with six news papers in New York agreeing to set up the news agency in 1848 but with strict restrictions on membership. This exclusiveness led to the formation of UPA in 1907, which later became United Press International (UPI) in 1959. The high cost of telegraphy gave the ground for ushering in **European cartel** with Reuters, Agence Havas and Wolff agreeing in 1865 to exclusive territories for their operation. The uncovered areas were considered as neutral territory, where any of them could operate. AP was a participating member of the cartel for many decades.

12.2.3 Reasons for Growth

Emerging freedom of the press in Germany, political turmoil in France, booming stock market across Europe, spreading of territorial colonialism, laying of the world's first undersea cable between Dover and Calais in November 1851 and the dynamic movements in the history of the world across the Atlantic and elsewhere created the best scenario for bulk and fast movement of news. News papers managed the show with a few correspondents but with several draw backs. Limited finance, means, manpower and resources of news papers came in the way of wider coverage of news. Only a handful of news papers could afford to station correspondents at various places for coverage of news. Instead of each news paper spending money to get the same news, a news agency could gather the news and distribute to the news papers at a fraction of a cost. As the proverbial "need is the mother of invention", a new system of gathering of news - News Agencies - sprouted with fledgling problems but sure enough to hit the market with a bang. The idea of news Agency, therefore, emerged as the solution for better informed in the fast changing world. The operation was galvanised with the world witnessing political upheavals and huge unprecedented technological advancements.

12.2.4 How is it Different from Newspapers?

News agencies job is to collect and distribute news. News papers print the news supplied by news agencies and their own correspondents and publish and sell the

papers to customers. News agencies are wholesalers as they distribute the same news to different news papers, while the news papers are retailers using it only for their publications. News agencies earn from the subscription given by news papers to meet its operation cost. News papers earn from selling the papers and also from advertisements to sustain their operation. News agencies' correspondents do not get credit line for their stories except in very special circumstances. But news papers give credit to their correspondents in most cases.

12.2.5 How an Agency Operates?

News agencies are run by journalists comprising both editors, reporters, correspondents. They also have photo journalists and camera persons to shoot news events. They prepare hard and soft news stories and feature articles and news video footages for selling them to other news organisations. Apart from news filed by their own correspondents, they also have tie-ups with other international news agencies. This helps them to tap a large quantum of news by way of exchanging news. These news items and feature articles are sent in bulk electronically through computer net work or internet with subscription service. Earlier, these were transmitted through wire services using telegraphy and received at the other end by teleprinters installed at the subscribers' offices.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What are the two primary functions of news agencies?
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2. List the three names of the pioneers of news agencies in Europe. How are their agencies known today?
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3. List three reasons for the growth of news agencies.
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4. What is the main difference between news agencies and news papers?
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12.3 GROWTH OF NEWS AGENCIES IN INDIA

12.3.1 Independence: State of Agencies

At the time of independence, Reuters' Indian arm - Associated Press of India (API) started in 1910 and another news agency United Press of India (UPI) started by B.Sengupta in 1933 were operating in the country. But, Reuters was having a sweeping monopoly over the business having a huge advantage because of the patronage of the British government. Its heavy official slant suited the government of the time. Another reason why UPI could come nowhere near API was its monopoly due to introduction of teleprinters in India in 1937 by Reuters. UPI got its first teleprinter service only in 1948 but the agency could not survive due to lack of enough support from news papers. It finally closed down in 1958. The Free Press Agency started by S.Sadanand in 1927 could not survive either and closed down in 1935 because of harassment of the colonial government.

12.3.2 Formation of Indian Agencies

Press Trust of India (PTI).

After the British left India in 1947, the idea of promoting India's own national news agency became vocal, though the thought was gaining momentum for over 2 years even before Independence. This led to the formation of Press Trust of India (PTI) on August 29, 1947 as a nonprofit company. Though, Reuters were initially unwilling to part with its Indian Subsidiary API, it fell in line and made PTI as its partner and handed over its internal business to it. But, the PTI – Reuters partnership was not smooth from the beginning. Donald Read in his book – History of Reuters- says “the historians of PTI have rightly expressed surprise that Reuters should ever have created PTI news zone, which included Pakistan.” The appointment of non – Indian correspondents in Karachi and Delhi was violation of the agreement by Reuters. Retaining the foreign news arm by Reuters often led to contradictions to the foreign policy of the free Indian government. After India became a Sovereign Republic in 1951, the projection of the nation's image abroad mattered a lot and Reuters' control over news going out of India was not agreeable to the government. So, PTI parted ways with Reuter's in 1953 and became the premier national news agency. With priority given to Indian news agencies and news papers in the allocation of teleprinter service after 1956, Reuters ended with just two staff correspondents in New Delhi and five stringers for sending news outside. Read says, “Some good reporting was still to come out of India: but the great days for Reuters – great in profit, great in prestige – were over.” On PTI's golden jubilee in 1999, President K R Narayanan said: “We got independence in August 1947. But independence in news and information we got only with the establishment of PTI in 1949. That is the significance of PTI.” Globalisation and the entry of new technology and internet have brought in a sea change in the media scenario and not just Reuters but other foreign agencies too have substantially increased their coverage from India now.

PTI's Web site says, “It employs more than 400 journalists and 500 stringers to cover almost every district and small towns in India. Collectively, they put out more than 2,000 stories and 200 photographs a day to feed the expansive appetite of the diverse subscribers, who include the mainstream media, the specialised presses, research groups, companies, and government and non-governmental organisations. PTI correspondents are also based in leading capitals

and important business and administrative centers around the world. Currently, it commands 90 per cent of new agency market share in India.”

PTI entered in to news exchange arrangements with several foreign news agencies including AP, AFP, the New York Times and Bloomberg etc. apart from placing its own correspondents in some world capitals. Major Indian subscribers of PTI include The Hindu, Times of India, the Indian Express, the Hindustan Times, the All India Radio and Doordarshan. PTI has offices in Bangkok, Beijing, Colombo, Dubai, Islamabad, Kuala Lumpur, Moscow, New York and Washington D.C. It is the only news agency in South Asia which operates its own communication satellite, an INSAT, to broadcast news and information.

Bhasha is the PTI’s Hindi language service to cater to the need of Hindi media. PTI has also other services in its stable.

United News of India (UNI):

After the UPI exited the scene in 1958, a need was felt for a second news agency for a better competition. And thus United News of India (UNI) was born in December 1959 and began its operation in 1961. Managing with old teleprinters of UPI initially, it soon assumed a significant share in the news agency business. It also entered in to collaboration agreement with Reuters and DPA for distribution of news. Besides it has news exchange agreement with Xinhua of China, UNB of Bangladesh, Gulf News Agency of Bahrain, and WAM of the United Arab Emirates, KUNA of Kuwait News Agency, ONA of Oman and QNA of Qatar. It has bureaux in all major cities and towns in India. Apart from covering news, UNI’s specialised output was News and Feature in agriculture, science reporting and stock market news. It has now more than 1000 subscribers in more than 100 locations in India and abroad. They include newspapers, All India Radio, Doordarshan, television networks, web sites, government offices and private and public sector corporations. Over 325 staff journalists around the country and 250 stringers are working for the agency. The agency also has correspondents in several world capitals including Washington, London Dubai, Colombo and other places. UNI became the first Indian news agency to serve subscribers abroad in 1981, selling its wire service directly to newspapers in the Arab states of the Persian Gulf and in Singapore through satellite channels. Its services are currently available in three languages: English, Hindi and Urdu. The Hindi language service, “UNIVARTA”, was launched on May 1, 1982, while the Urdu service began in June 1992. UNI is said to be the first news agency in India to launch a Finance service, a Stock Exchange service and a National Photo service.

Indo-Asian News Services (IANS)

It was set up by Gopal Raju, founder of India Abroad in 1986 to boost news flow from India to Indian Diaspora in North America initially. Now it sends news from India and South Asia region across the world besides to the fast growing media in India. The subscribers include print and broadcast media, publishers, government departments, foreign missions etc. IANS has developed 6 units English, Hindi, Publishing, Business Consultancy, Solutions, and Mobile.

Its web site says, “With India’s growing importance in international strategic and economic thinking, news about the country is becoming more critical to the world. India alone accounts for over a billion of South Asia’s 1.3 billion people. The sheer mass creates news.”

ANI was set up by Prem Prakash about half a century ago and it became a multimedia news agency providing content to TV, Internet, broadband, newspapers and mobiles etc. Its TV Service provides news and features to broadcasters at home and abroad and multilingual programmes for international viewers interested in South Asia. It has a text capsule service giving top news with features health and entertainment content. ANI has a TV Archives with extensive footage of South Asia. ANI's website says, "A large portion of the footage has historical value and has been preserved in beta and digital format. The library has over two hundred thousand news and current affairs video items which are logged and categorised in an easy to access manner."

12.3.3 Emergency: A Watershed

The emergency declared by the Prime Minister Indira Gandhi on 26 June 1975 not only suspended all civil liberties but also the freedom of the press. It was in force for 19 months till 21 March 1977. Apart from censorship, the functioning of the news agencies also came in for scrutiny. The government considered merging all the four news Agencies – PTI, UNI and multilingual agencies, Hindustan Samachar and Samachar Bharati - to make it one national news agency under the Act of Parliament as corporate body. Later, the four agencies merged as one agency and it was registered as a society with name Samachar. And thus, Samachar was born with its news items coming out from 1 February 1976. The mid seventies also happened to be the decade of developing countries asserting for a new information order with the 4th Non-Aligned countries summit in Algiers in 1973 endorsing a Non Aligned News Agencies Pool. This was to remove the shortcomings and slants of the western news agencies reporting on events in developing nations. The move culminated in setting up Non-Aligned News Agencies Pool (NANAP) in 1976 and Samachar became the Indian partner of the pool. Besides its English service, it also had Hindi and Marathi services. K.M. Srivastava, in his book "News Agencies: Pigeon to internet" says Samachar became a major issue in 1977 elections, and after the defeat of Indira Gandhi, the fate of the new entity was sealed". There were several suggestions for its re-structuring but nothing worked out. Finally, on 14 November 1977, the government announced that "Samachar was a product and symbol of Emergency and indeed an aberration of Emergency. News agencies forced to merge together under pressure and against their will during Emergency should be allowed to function independently as they were before" So, the four agencies again started functioning independently from 14 April 1978.

12.3.4 Growth of Language Wings

Hindustan Samachar

It is the first multi lingual news agency set up in India in 1948 as a limited company in the then Bombay, now Mumbai. The agency says, it was formed with an objective to give a vent to the voice of millions of Indians. Bihar Government subscribed to it in 1951 and later several state governments including Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Punjab, Haryana, Bihar, Rajasthan, Odisha, Assam, Karnataka and Kerala became subscribers. Nepal Radio was its subscriber from 1953 and All India Radio joined the list in 1968 followed by Doordarshan. Though it was allowed to function independently after emergency was lifted, it stopped functioning in 1986 due what it said some unavoidable reason. A new

Beginning was made in 2000 as share holders of the Hindusthan Samachar thought it prudent to restart the agency.

Today Hindusthan Samachar provides news in 14 Indian languages and efforts are on to add more. The agency's web site says, "Presently the service is being provided in Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, Nepali, Oriya, Asamiya, Kannad, Tamil, Malayalam, Telugu, Sindhi, Sanskrit, Punjabi and Bangla. The service is fully based on the web internet technology". The subscriber can either download the text or convert it into E-mail format. A pass word is given to them to down load the news.

Samachar Bharati

Another Language agency Samachar Bharati was started in 1962 and distribution of news began in 1967. It is a bilingual news and photo wire service giving news in English and Hindi. With the central office in Delhi and head office in Bhopal with bureaux in Lucknow, Jaipur, Patna, and Ahmedabad, the agency had several news papers, state governments and All India Radio as its subscribers. It also runs a feature service Bharati. The agency started an online service in 2013 known as, Samachar Bharti Online News Agency (SBONA). The agency's web site says, "We focus on national and global processes affecting the economic, social and political development of the people of India in particular and the region in general."

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. List the two agencies that were functioning in India at the time of Independence.

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2. List the two major news Agencies formed in India after independence

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3. Give at least two reasons for forming Non – Aligned News Agency Pool in mid seventies.

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4. List at least two reasons given by the government for scrapping Samachar.

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12.4 OWNERSHIP PATTERNS & REVENUE SOURCES

12.4.1 Ownership Patterns

News Agencies' ownership pattern ranges from private companies, corporations and cooperatives to government owned. News agencies initially started as commercial ventures but soon turned out as cooperatives with news papers becoming major share holders to run the agencies. This model of ownership was adopted by some top news agencies like Associated Press AP, AFP, American Press Agency – APA, PTI, UNI etc. Some news agencies became corporations to sell news. Reuters, United Press International, Press Association etc came under this model. Some were privately owned as well. Samachar Bharati, ANI, IANS etc would fall in his category. Government also run news agency like Xinhua in China, ITAR-TASS in Russia. Other countries also have government-funded news agencies. AP, a non cooperative, had two types of membership - regular and associate. Associate members had no voting right.

12.4.2 Financial Structure

Subscriptions and commercial revenues are the major incomes for the news agencies, particularly from the home market and therefore fundamentally they had national characters. . Oliver Boyd –Barrett in his book “The international news agencies” aptly titles the chapter “ “Business begins at Home”. News papers are major share holders and subscribers to run the news agencies. This model suited both. News agencies got committed clients and news papers got cost effective news supply. This was possible because news agencies collected news and distributed the same news to many news papers cutting down the cost of gathering of news to a fraction. News papers and other clients paid subscription for the service. Financially, it was prudent and operationally productive. PTI has more than 450 news papers as subscribers. Its major Indian subscribers include The Hindu, Times of India, the Indian Express, the Hindustan Times, the All India Radio and Doordarshan. PTI entered in to news exchange arrangements with several other news agencies including more than 100 news agencies outside India. These include AP, AFP, the New York Times and Bloomberg etc. It has an exchange arrangement with AP and AFP for foreign content for a payment. AP subscribes to PTI news service at a monthly subscription. UNI has no exchange mechanism but distributes daily news package from Reuters to its subscribers on the rates fixed for monthly or yearly subscriptions. The subscription charges are fixed according to the circulation of news papers as per the figure of Audit Bureau of Circulation. The other income source was commercial.

12.4.3 Organisational Structure

PTI is a non-profit cooperative. The managerial responsibilities are carried out by a Board of Directors with the Chairmanship rotated at the Annual General Meeting. Of the 15 Board members, 13 are from news papers. But, the day-to-day administration and management of PTI is headed by the Chief Executive Officer, who is also the Editor-in-Chief. The pattern is not much different for other news agencies, which function as non – profit cooperative models. For instance AP has president as CEO. This may not be the case for news agencies like Xinhua in China, ITAR-TASS in Russia.

The editorial wing of PTI is headed by the Editor in chief, who is in charge of the collection, editing and distribution of the news. General Managers (very senior editors) come next in the system. Editorial desks and reporting are the key functions, though operational staff including a technical team is required to run the show. The news gathering is also done by Bureux set up in major cities and towns across the country and outside headed by Bureau Chiefs. Each Bureau may have one or more than one correspondent and reporters. The news filed by them will take care of regional news papers' need as well as the national and international press.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. List four ownership patterns of news agencies.

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2. What are the two major sources of revenue of news agencies?

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3. List at least two key functions of operational staff of news agencies.

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12.5 DIFFERENCES IN OPERATION: NEWS AGENCIES AND NEWS PAPERS

We have briefly touched this subject in the previous section. Though both the news agencies and news papers share the same business, their mode of operation is different. Barring the news collected by their own correspondents, news papers rely on news agencies for news. In other words, news agencies also become a source for news for news papers. News agencies have no printing responsibilities though their style of writing is for print. Unlike the news papers, they have no space constraints. Therefore they have no word limit for their news copies. But news papers limit their copies or modify them according to the space available for print. News agencies don't have any deadline and work round the clock, while newspapers have print deadline as the papers have to hit the streets on time. News agencies have bureaux with a set of staff in cities for wide coverage but news papers have correspondents and in most of the cases a single person for limited coverage.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. List five differences in the operation of news agencies and news papers.

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12.6 FOREIGN AGENCIES IN INDIA

12.6.1 Main Agencies Working in India

Some of the main foreign news agency working in India are: Reuters (London), AFP (Paris), AP(New York), DPA News Agency, Hamburg, Bloomberg News, New York, Dow Jones Newswire, New York, ITAR-TASS, Moscow, Xinhua News Agency, China, Gulf News, Dubai ,IRNA (Islamaic Republic News Agency), Tehran, Inter Press Service, Rome, ANSA (Agenzia Nazionale Stampa Associata), Rome, Associated Press of Pakistan etc.

12.6.2 Operation of Foreign Agencies

The Foreign news agencies have bureax in New Delhi being the capital and news Centre of India. Some of them have offices in Mumbai being the financial capital of India to get financial news. Large news agencies like Reuters, AFP, and AP have correspondents and or stringers to collect news across the country besides having tie ups with Indian news agencies PTI or UNI for exchange of news. They also buy TV footage from agencies like ANI. News gathered by them is sent to their headquarters by dedicated wire services or internet or other modern communication systems like satellite antennas. These are re-distributed to their customers worldwide.

Check Your Progress 5

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. List at least five major foreign news agencies operating in India with their headquarters.

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2. How do they send their news to their headquarters?

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12.7 FEATURE AGENCIES AND SERVICES

12.7.1 Agencies and How they Operate

All news agencies have feature sections for detailed reporting of news based stories. Because, the readers of news papers or listeners of Radio or viewers of TV news want not only spot news but also details of the events or developments. This cannot be given in normal news reporting, which is short and brief. The desire to know background, various view points and an in depth knowledge of the events is ever increasing with the world hurtling towards a highly knowledge based society. This can be covered only by features, analysis etc. Feature sections, therefore, focus on detailed treatment of the subject. PTI has a feature service to give four weekly features on topical issues. UNI pioneered feature services in Agriculture in the late 60s. Today, mid pages of news papers and also special pages brought out by them deal with a number of subjects. Some of them print features of New York Times service on many burning world issues.

India News and Feature Alliance (INFA) is one of the pioneers of news and features agency in the country. Founded by Durga Das, former editor in chief of Hindustan Times in 1959, it is an independent syndicate. Its service includes daily columns, off beat news items, backgrounders and special features. There are also other feature agencies both online and off line to offer interesting features and articles.

12.7.2 Syndicated Columnists

A journalist can also work as a syndicated columnist, if his recurring columns are published in multiple news papers and periodicals. Newspapers syndicated services distribute material to many publications. For instance the columns appearing in New York Times with credit lines are distributed and published in many national papers in India and outside. Online syndication services also do the same.

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. State the main difference between news and news features.

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2. Who is a syndicated columnist?

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12.8 CHALLENGES & OPPORTUNITIES

12.8.1 Competition and Diversification

Competition is not new to news agencies. It was there right from the beginning. The high cost of telegraphy gave the ground for European cartel with Reuters, Agence Havas and Wolff agreeing in 1865 to exclusive territories for their operation. They dominated the world scene almost till the World War II. Across the Atlantic, Associated Press (AP)'s policy of strict restrictions on membership led to formation of a rival agency United Press International (UPI) in 1907.

The world now is witnessing information explosion in the past two decades with myriad TV channels bombarding the homes with information 24x7. Technology has gone much ahead of the people's imagination and even policy makers. With the Television channels, internet and mobile phones taking away a chunk of the advertisement funds available in the market, even news papers had to re-invent themselves to face the competition. Many of them had to drastically cut the cost of the cost of the paper and to come up with special pull outs on metro, city, Film world and other news to increase readership. News Agencies were not spared by its impact either. Diversification of revenue had become the inevitable need of the hour. Therefore, today's news agencies have widened their operation by launching several services to increase their revenue.

PTI had come out with:

Stock Scan: To give stock market information on video screen.

News Scan: To give important news on video screen

Data India: To give weekly news digests.

Economic Service: To give fortnightly analyses on economy.

News Magazine of special stories, Science Service, Graphics, photo and other services are also offered by PTI.

UNI's special services are:

- UNI Darshan (TV news and features)
- UNI Scan (News display on TV sets for hotels, and government or corporate clients)
- UNI Direct (Services for executives in government, corporate and other sectors)
- UNI Graphics (Ready-to-use computer-designed graphics)
- UNI Internet News Service
- UNI Story Editor (Online Story Tracking System)

Other news agencies have also widened their services in a similar pattern.

12.8.2 Clientele

Every beginning is hard, so also getting a client or customer for professional groups like news agencies. Donald Reed in his book says, "Julius Reuter later liked to tell how on one occasion he had gone to a chop-house nearby, when his young assistant rushed in to say that 'a foreign looking sort of gentleman had called to see him. Reuter asked the boy why he had let the man go.' Please, sir, I didn't' was the answer.' He is still at the office. I've locked him in.' Thus was one of Reuter's first customer was secured." Though news papers were the first clients of news agencies, it has widened its operations to radio, television channels and practically billions of people owning mobile phones with news alert and text service. This expansion of clientele is still on.

12.8.3 Multimedia

Print journalism occupied the centre stage of the media earlier but not anymore. The scenario has dramatically changed from print to television to internet to mobile and so on. As technology advanced, there arose a great demand for multimedia news contents. Print alone was not sufficient. News has to be communicated through videos, photos, audio bites, small texts etc. Most of the news agencies, therefore, shifted to multimedia operations as otherwise they may not survive the market dynamics. Reuters has become world's largest International Multimedia news provider with real-time, high-impact, multimedia news and information services. Primary Indian news agencies have all shifted to multimedia operations. Reuters have come up professional news solutions using multimedia. A Broadcast video helps to choose from raw news footage with natural sound and ready-to-air packages to live exclusive reports. Its newswires will connect for engaging with target audiences across the globe. Its online service provides updated news packages and solutions for digital platforms. A picture service provides feeds of up-to-the-minute photographs. News video graphs provides visual analysis of world events. ANI uses the latest in Internet technology with websites and broadband to provide exclusive video, audio, text and picture content for web users. It also provides multilingual package of audio, video, SMS and MMS content for mobiles.

12.8.4 Internet service

No other platform has grown faster than internet. *It provided another base for alternative news agencies and source of news. It was Inter Press, which*

started distribution of news over internet in 1994 using a website set up by – TLELNOR - a telecommunication company of Norway. Visitors could see only the first line of the news. Only subscribers could access to the full news item. Today, almost all the news agencies have similar services on their websites.

Check Your Progress 7

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Give at least 3 major clients of News agencies.

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2. List at least three different multimedia news contents.

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3. How do the agencies use internet and earn from their service?

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12.9 LET US SUM UP

In this unit, we studied the primary function of a news agency, its origin and names of the pioneers in Europe and growth and the reasons for its growth. The difference between a news agency and news papers and why it is cost effective were analysed. The formation and operation of world's leading news agencies, Indian news agencies and language wings were considered at length. The reasons for forming Non – aligned pool, the formation of Samachar and its closer were looked in to. The four types of ownership, two key functions of a news agency and two major resources for revenue were studied along with organisational set up and the whole range of functioning of the news agencies. The main difference between news and news features and two key functions of operational staff were discussed. The need for feature services by news agencies and the role of syndicated columnists was also considered. The focus was on major foreign news agencies operating in India and the their operation for sending news gathered by them to their headquarters and clients within India by dedicated wire services or computer net work or internet or other modern communication systems using satellite antennas. The need for syndicated columnists and major clients of

the news agencies were reviewed. The demand for multimedia news contents and the news agencies diversifying their operation were also seen as an inevitable choice of the news agencies now. You may not have missed Internet emerging as an important tool for new agencies to expand their operation.

12.10 KEYWORDS

Footages	:	Video clippings of news events
European cartel	:	An arrangement made by three news agencies Reuters, Agence Havas and Wolff in 1865 to exclusive territories for their operation.
Undersea cable	:	A cable laid on the sea bed between land based stations to carry telecommunication signals.
Teleprinters	:	An electro-mechanical typewriter that can be used to send and receive typed messages from point to point.
Broadband	:	Wide bandwidth of a transmission medium for sending or receiving multiple signals simultaneously.
TV Archives	:	Storing of video footages.
Beta and digital format	:	records compressed digital component video signals.
Bureau	:	a branch office of a news agency
Multimedia	:	Media and components that uses a combination of different contend forms.
Audio bites	:	Recorded portion of speech or other audio inputs.
Raw news footage	:	Un-edited video footages
Digital platforms	:	Audio or video or data transmission in the real-time or delayed mode in networks.
A picture service	:	sending photos electronically
Feeds	:	A web feed or news feed is a data format used for providing users with frequently updated content.

12.11 FURTHER READINGS

K. MShrivastava, 2007, *News Agencies from Pigeon to Internet*, New Dawn Press Group.

Donald Read, 1999, *POWER OF NEWS, THE HISTORY OF REUTERS*, Oxford University Press. Oliver Boyd- Barret, 1980, *The international news agencies*, SAGE Publications, Beverly Hills, California.

12.12 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check your Progress 1

1. Two two primary functions of news agencies are gathering and distribution of news.
2. Three names of the pioneers of news agencies in Europe: Charles Havas started "Bureau Havas" in 1851 in Paris and it became Agence France - Presse (AFP) later. Julius Reuters launched "Reuters" in 1851 in London and it is known by the same name today. Bernard Wolff started Wolff of Prussia in 1849 in Berlin and it couldn't survive as a major news agency after World War 1.
3. Three reasons for the growth of news agencies: a) The fast changing world political scenario and industrial development in the mid nineteenth century and later years created a great demand for news flow. b) The huge growth of telegraphy after the laying of the first undersea cable between Dover and Calais in November 1851. c) Sharing of news with many clients made it cost effective.
4. The main difference between news agencies and news Papers is News agencies gather and distribute news and news papers print the news and sell the papers.

Check Your Progress 2

1. Two agencies that were functioning in India at the time of Independence are Reuters' Indian Arm - Associated Press of India (API) and United Press of India (UPI).
2. The two major news Agencies that were formed in India after independence are Press Trust of India (PTI) in August 1947 and United News of India (UNI) in 1958.
3. Shortcomings and slant of the western news agencies' reporting on events in developing nations were the reasons for forming Non – Aligned News Agency Pool in mid seventies.
4. The government scrapped Samachar in 1977 saying it was an aberration of Emergency and news agencies were forced to merge together under pressure.

Check Your Progress 3

1. Four ownership patterns of news agencies: Cooperatives, Corporate, state owned and private.
2. Subscription and commercial income are the two major sources of revenue of news agencies?
3. Editorial and reporting are the two key functions of operational staff of news agencies.

Check Your Progress 4

1. Five differences in the operation of news agencies and news papers are:
a) News agencies have a wide net work of correspondents to cover the news
b) they are a source of news, c) have no word limit for news, d) no page space constraints, e) no deadline.

News papers have a) limited number of correspondents, b) users of the agencies as source, c) have word limit, d) have page space constraints, and e) have print deadline.

Check Your Progress 5

1. Five major foreign news agencies operating in India are; Reuters (London), AFP (Paris), AP (New York), DPA (Hamburg) and ITAR-TASS (Moscow).
2. Foreign news agencies send the news gathered by them to their headquarters and clients within India by dedicated wire services or computer net work or internet or other modern communication systems using satellite antennas. These are re-distributed to their customers worldwide.

Check Your Progress 6

1. The main difference between news and news features is that news is brief account of the events, while features are detailed and lengthy treatment of the event.
2. A journalist is known as syndicated columnist, if his recurring columns are published in multiple news papers and periodicals.

Check Your Progress 7

1. Three major clients of News agencies are: News papers, government departments and radio and television news channels.
2. Three different multimedia news contents: News packages for print, video, and mobile phones.
3. Agencies use internet by posting the news on their web sites. The visitors can only see the news very briefly. The subscribers can access to the full news. This gives the new agencies income.